PRESS KIT

INKTENEBRIS · Dark Surreal Ballpoint Pen Art

Artist: Soumalya Sarkar
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ARTIST OVERVIEW

Soumalya Sarkar is an independent dark surreal artist working primarily with ballpoint pen. Through INKTENEBRIS, he explores themes of identity, transformation, memory, psychological horror, isolation and subconscious imagery. His work combines meticulous mark-making with symbolic visual narratives that exist between dreamlike experiences and unsettling realities.

ARTIST STATEMENT

INKTENEBRIS is an ongoing exploration of darkness, identity, memory and transformation. Working exclusively with ballpoint pen, I create surreal monochromatic drawings that emerge through thousands of deliberate marks and layers of ink. My work is influenced by psychological horror, dream imagery, isolation and the hidden structures of the subconscious. Human forms dissolve, familiar objects become unsettling, and fragments of memory are reconstructed into visual narratives. Rather than presenting direct answers, these drawings invite interpretation. They exist in the space between beauty and discomfort, familiarity and distortion, reality and imagination. The slow and demanding nature of ballpoint pen drawing is central to the process. Every mark is permanent. Every layer contributes to an image that gradually emerges from darkness. Through INKTENEBRIS, I seek to create artwork that lingers beyond the moment it is seen—images that provoke curiosity, unease and reflection while remaining open to personal meaning.

QUICK FACTS

Artist: Soumalya Sarkar
Artist name: INKTENEBRIS
Location: India, West Bengal
Medium: Ballpoint Pen on Paper
Style: Dark Surrealism

SELECTED WORKS

01 — **The Hollow One**
A surreal ballpoint pen illustration exploring curiosity, transformation and the unknown. The butterfly becomes a fragile contrast against a figure emerging from darkness, suggesting both decay and rebirth.

02 — **Metamorphosis**
A psychological portrait depicting inner conflict, transformation and emotional decay. The distorted anatomy represents the struggle between identity and self perception.

03 — **The Observer**
An unsettling study of perception and silent presence. The single eye exists between darkness and awareness, suggesting a watcher hidden beyond ordinary sight.

04 — **Smile Without Eyes**
A portrait suspended between familiarity and dread. The expression remains frozen in an impossible smile, while

the absence of eyes removes every trace of human comfort and emotion.

05 — **Unhinged**
A study of emotional collapse and distorted anatomy. The figure appears trapped between transformation and destruction, creating tension through impossible forms and exaggerated expression.

06 — **The Hand That Sees**
A surreal fusion of touch and perception. The eye emerges from the hand as a symbol of awareness, suggesting that understanding can come through instinct, memory and sensation rather than sight alone.

07 — **The Clown Below**
A distorted clown figure emerging from darkness, balancing absurdity and dread. The exaggerated features transform a familiar symbol of entertainment into something unsettling and psychologically ambiguous.

08 — **Sewn Flesh**
Fragments stitched together in an attempt to become whole. The piece explores trauma, repair and identity, where every scar becomes evidence of survival rather than a mark of weakness.

09 — **Watcher**
A silent presence emerging from darkness. The elongated form and hollow gaze create a feeling of being observed from somewhere beyond the visible world.

10 — **Without Eyes**
A faceless figure emerging from absolute darkness. The absence of eyes removes every anchor of human connection, leaving only an oppressive sense of being watched by something that sees without being seen.

CONTACT

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